ahava
Christian Counseling & Services

Free guide

Rebuild

First steps to healing emotional wounds



Dr. Emilia Arnaud, PhD
Christian Counselor · Ahava Christian Counseling & Services

Welcome

If you are carrying hurt from the past, you are not weak and you are not alone. Painful experiences can leave the body and mind on alert long after they are over.

Healing usually happens step by step. This guide offers gentle first steps. Go at your own pace, and skip anything that feels like too much today.

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How to use this guide

- Go slowly. One page a day is enough.
- Use a pen. Writing helps you think and remember.
- Be honest and kind with yourself. There are no wrong answers.
- Follow the 7-day plan at the end, or go at your own pace.

Where are you today?

Circle a number for each sentence. 1 = not true for me, 5 = very true for me.

I often feel on edge or easily startled.	1	2	3	4	5
Some memories still feel very close.	1	2	3	4	5
I sometimes feel numb or far away.	1	2	3	4	5
I react strongly and don’t always know why.	1	2	3	4	5
It’s hard for me to trust others.	1	2	3	4	5
I have at least one safe person to talk to.	1	2	3	4	5

Keep your answers. In a few weeks, try again and notice what has changed.

Four steps to begin

1

Come back to the present

When old pain is stirred up, the body can react as if the danger is happening now. Grounding helps you come back to the here and now.

YOUR TURN

Try 5-4-3-2-1: name 5 things you see, 4 you can touch, 3 you hear, 2 you smell and 1 you taste. How do you feel afterward?

2

Breathe to calm your body

Slow breathing tells your body it is safe. Breathe in for 4 counts, hold for 2, and breathe out for 6. Repeat five times.

YOUR TURN

When could you practice this each day?

Morning:

Afternoon:

Night:

3

Notice your triggers with kindness

A trigger is something that brings old feelings back. Noticing triggers, without judging yourself, gives you more choice.

YOUR TURN

Think of one moment this week when you felt upset.

What happened: _____

What I felt in my body: _____

What helped me: _____

4

Build your circle of support

Healing happens in safe relationships. You don't have to share everything to start feeling supported.

YOUR TURN

Write the names of one to three people or places where you feel safe.

_____

_____

_____

A moment with God

Read these verses in your Bible, slowly. Then write what stands out to you.

Psalm 34:18 **Isaiah 41:10**

What would it mean for you to know that God is close to you in your pain?

Your 7-day plan

One small action a day. Check each box when you're done.

- [ ] **Day 1** Read this guide slowly.
- [ ] **Day 2** Practice 5-4-3-2-1 once.
- [ ] **Day 3** Do the breathing exercise twice.
- [ ] **Day 4** Notice one trigger, with kindness.
- [ ] **Day 5** Do something that comforts you.
- [ ] **Day 6** Reach out to one safe person.
- [ ] **Day 7** Write one thing that helped you this week.

Your next step

Rebuild

This guide is a beginning. In a free 15-minute call, you can talk with Dr. Emilia Arnaud about your path and see if one-on-one sessions are right for you. Online or in person, in English or Portuguese.

Or call or send a WhatsApp message:
(954) 899-3979 · wa.me/19548993979

Scan to book your free call

If writing about the past feels like too much, stop and return to the grounding or breathing exercise. You don't have to do this alone. If you are ever in danger, call 911. For a mental health crisis in the U.S., call or text 988.

This guide is for education and personal reflection. It is not a diagnosis and does not replace counseling or medical care.

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